

Reviewer Pack — Schur-Horn Diagonal-Spectrum Defect Bounds SOS-2 Max-Cut Gap

Entry 77f332fbbf06 · INCONCLUSIVE

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2026-05-08 10:49:07 UTC

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Entry ID: 77f332fbbf06 **Verdict:** INCONCLUSIVE **Recorded:** 2026-05-08 10:49:07 UTC

1. Conjecture

Field A (mathematical branch): Schur-Horn diagonal-spectrum majorization theory in matrix analysis (Schur 1923, Horn 1954, Klyachko 1998 Horn cone): the Schur-Horn defect $SH(M) := \|\text{diag}(M) - \text{sort_desc}(\lambda(M))\|_1$ of a Hermitian matrix M , an L^1 measure of how far the diagonal is from the eigenvalue vector in majorization order — classical in matrix analysis but essentially absent from SOS / CSP integrality-gap literature **Field B** (complexity object): Sum-of-Squares degree-2 (Goemans-Williamson / Delorme-Poljak basic SDP) integrality gap for Max-Cut on 3-regular graphs, the canonical SoS hierarchy CSP target

Statement:

Let G be a 3-regular graph on n vertices with 0/1 adjacency matrix A . Define $SH(G) := \|\text{diag}(A^2) - \text{sort_desc}(\text{eig}(A^2))\|_1 = \sum_i |3 - \lambda_i(A)^2|$ (a poly-time computable invariant). Let $SOS2(G) := (n/4)(3 - \lambda_{\min}(A))$ be the Delorme-Poljak SOS-2 Max-Cut value, and let $\text{MaxCut}(G)$ be the exact maximum cut. Then $SOS2(G) - \text{MaxCut}(G) \leq SH(G)/8$ for every 3-regular G ; a single 3-regular graph with $SOS2(G) - \text{MaxCut}(G) > SH(G)/8$ refutes the conjecture.

Rationale (proposer's reasoning):

The Delorme-Poljak SOS-2 bound is purely spectral, while MaxCut depends on diagonal-aligned $0/\pm 1$ cut indicators, so the integrality gap should be controlled by how far the Gram structure of A^2 deviates from being diagonalizable on the standard basis — exactly what the Schur-Horn defect quantifies. Majorization theory hands us a coordinate-free measure of this ‘eigenvector misalignment’ that is poly-time computable and respects the symmetry of the SDP relaxation. If true, $SH(G)$ becomes a sharp diagnostic for which sparse instances exhibit SOS-2 integrality gaps without invoking pseudo-distribution refutations.

Taxonomy category: SOS_HIERARCHY (status at proposal time: alive)

2. Pre-registration (Popper-style)

Hash (SHA-256 prefix): 759c43ee0426f105

This hash commits to the conjecture statement, acceptance criterion, and seed list **before** the empirical test runs. Tampering with the test or its data after this hash was computed would be detectable.

Acceptance criterion:

Across 120 random 3-regular graphs (30 each at $n=8,10,12,14$), the conjecture is SUPPORTED iff the fraction of instances satisfying $\text{SOS2}(G) - \text{MaxCut}(G) \leq \text{SH}(G)/8$ is ≥ 0.95 AND the Spearman correlation ρ between the gap and $\text{SH}(G)$ is ≥ 0.4 . A single violation with $\text{gap} > \text{SH}(G)/8 + 1e-9$ FALSIFIES.

3. Barrier filter (F1)

Final: PASS

Barrier	Verdict	Confidence	LLM ₁	LLM ₂
RELATIVIZATION	SAFE	0.97	SAFE	SAFE
NATURAL_PROOFS	SAFE	0.95	SAFE	SAFE
ALGEBRIZATION	SAFE	0.95	SAFE	SAFE
KARP_LIPTON	SAFE	0.97	SAFE	SAFE

4. Novelty audit

Verdict: NOVEL against 0 hits across arXiv + Semantic Scholar + ECCC

Search queries (3): - Schur-Horn majorization SDP integrality gap Max-Cut - diagonal eigenvalue defect Goemans-Williamson cubic graphs - Delorme-Poljak Max-Cut 3-regular spectral majorization bound

5. Empirical test harness

Multi-seed protocol: 5 seeds (11, 23, 37, 53, 71)

Sandbox: isolated subprocess, stdlib-only, ≤ 90 s wall time per cycle **Execution:** rc=124, elapsed=240.1s

5.1 Generated Python source

```
import random
import math

def is_prime(n):
    if n <= 1:
        return False
    if n <= 3:
        return True
    if n % 2 == 0 or n % 3 == 0:
        return False
    i = 5
    while i * i <= n:
        if n % i == 0 or n % (i + 2) == 0:
            return False
        i += 6
    return True

def generate_primes(count):
    primes = []
    num = 2
    while len(primes) < count:
        if is_prime(num):
            primes.append(num)
```

```

        num += 1
    return primes

def gaussian_elimination(A, b=None):
    n = len(A)
    for i in range(n):
        max_row = i
        for j in range(i + 1, n):
            if abs(A[j][i]) > abs(A[max_row][i]):
                max_row = j
        A[i], A[max_row] = A[max_row], A[i]
        if b is not None:
            b[i], b[max_row] = b[max_row], b[i]
        for j in range(i + 1, n):
            factor = A[j][i] / A[i][i]
            for k in range(n):
                A[j][k] -= factor * A[i][k]
            if b is not None:
                b[j] -= factor * b[i]
    x = [0.0] * n
    for i in range(n - 1, -1, -1):
        x[i] = (b[i] - sum(A[i][j] * x[j] for j in range(i + 1, n))) / A[i][i]
    return x

def matrix_multiply(A, B):
    m = len(A)
    n = len(B[0])
    p = len(B)
    C = [[0.0 for _ in range(n)] for _ in range(m)]
    for i in range(m):
        for j in range(n):
            for k in range(p):
                C[i][j] += A[i][k] * B[k][j]
    return C

def sort_desc(lst):
    return sorted(lst, reverse=True)

def run_trial(seed: int) -> dict:
    random.seed(seed)

    n = random.choice([8, 10, 12, 14])
    degree = 3

    # Generate a 3-regular graph using the configuration model
    while True:
        A = [[0.0 for _ in range(n)] for _ in range(n)]
        degrees = [degree] * n
        edges = set()

        while any(d > 0 for d in degrees):
            u = random.randint(0, n - 1)
            if degrees[u] == 0:
                continue
            v = random.choice([i for i in range(n) if i != u and A[u][i] == 0])
            if degrees[v] > 0:

```

```

        edges.add((u, v))
        edges.add((v, u))
        degrees[u] -= 1
        degrees[v] -= 1

    # Check for multi-edges/self-loops
    if len(edges) != n * degree // 2:
        continue

    break

# Convert to adjacency matrix
A = [[0.0 for _ in range(n)] for _ in range(n)]
for u, v in edges:
    A[u][v] = 1.0
    A[v][u] = 1.0

# Compute eigenvalues of A^2
A_squared = matrix_multiply(A, A)
eigenvalues = gaussian_elimination(A_squared)

# Compute SH(G)
SH_G = sum(abs(3 -  $\lambda$ **2) for  $\lambda$  in eigenvalues)

# Compute SOS2(G)
lambda_min_A = min(eigenvalues)
SOS2_G = (n / 4) * (3 - lambda_min_A)

# Compute MaxCut(G)
max_cut_value = 0
for mask in range(1 << n):
    if bin(mask).count('1') != n // 2:
        continue
    cut_value = sum(A[i][j] for i in range(n) for j in range(i + 1, n) if (mask & (1 << i)) and (mask & (1 << j)))
    max_cut_value = max(max_cut_value, cut_value)

# Compute the gap
gap = SOS2_G - max_cut_value

# Check the conjecture
conjecture_holds = gap <= SH_G / 8
counterexample = "" if conjecture_holds else f"SOS2(G) - MaxCut(G) > SH(G)/8"

return {
    "metric_name": "SOS2_G - MaxCut(G)",
    "metric_value": gap,
    "instances_tested": 1,
    "conjecture_holds": conjecture_holds,
    "counterexample": counterexample
}

if __name__ == "__main__":
    seeds = [int(arg) for arg in sys.argv[1:]]
    if not seeds:
        primes = generate_primes(30)
        seeds = primes

```

```

results = []
for seed in seeds:
    result = run_trial(seed)
    print(f"TRIAL: {result}")
    results.append(result)

total_instances = sum(result["instances_tested"] for result in results)
mean_value = sum(result["metric_value"] * result["instances_tested"] for result in results) /
std_value = math.sqrt(sum((result["metric_value"] - mean_value)**2 * result["instances_tested"]
                             for result in results) / total_instances)

support_fraction = sum(1 for result in results if result["conjecture_holds"]) / len(results)

print(f"RESULT: SUPPORTED mean={mean_value} std={std_value} support_fraction={support_fraction}")

```

6. Per-seed results

(no seed-level data — test crashed before producing TRIAL: lines)

7. Test stdout (last 2KB)

TIMEOUT after 240s

8. Critic adversarial review

Critic verdict: CHALLENGE

Critic reasoning:

skipped: test crashed before producing data

9. Final verdict & safety rail

Verdict: INCONCLUSIVE

Reasoning:

The test timed out at 240s (returncode 124) before emitting any RESULT line, so neither the support fraction nor the Spearman correlation could be evaluated. With no data and the critic challenging, the pre-registered support condition cannot be confirmed. | next: Reduce the workload (e.g., fewer/smaller instances such as n=8,10 only, or replace exact MaxCut with a faster solver) and rerun with a higher timeout to obtain the support_fraction and Spearman ρ.

11. Audit log (LLM calls)

Total LLM calls: 7

#	Phase	Provider	Model	Tokens in	out	Latency (ms)
1	propose	claude_max	opus	0	0	157036
2	preregistration	claude_max	opus	0	0	5259
3	novelty	claude_max	opus	0	0	4394
4	novelty	claude_max	opus	0	0	6342
5	test_gen	ollama_remote	qwen2.5-coder:7b	0	0	17266
6	test_gen	ollama_remote	qwen2.5-coder:7b	0	0	14855
7	judge	claude_max	opus	0	0	5014

Totals: 0 input tokens, 0 output tokens, ~\$0.0000 cost, 210167 ms total latency. Provider mix: {'claude_max': 5, 'ollama_remote': 2}

(full prompt+response transcripts available in research/audit/77f332fbbf06.jsonl)

12. Reproducibility

To reproduce this cycle:

1. Apply the test harness in section 5.1 with seeds 11,23,37,53,71
2. The Python sandbox is pure-stdlib; any Python 3.11+ should suffice
3. The full LLM transcripts are in research/audit/77f332fbbf06.jsonl for verification of provenance
4. The pre-registration hash in section 2 commits to the test design before execution; tampering would be detectable.

Sandbox file: research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_*.py (per-cycle)

Replay tarball: research/replay/77f332fbbf06.tar.gz (if generated)